

TARBIYYAH GLOBAL ACADEMY
Part of the Tarbiyyah Education Trust · globalacademy.tarbiyyah.co.uk · globalacademy@tarbiyyah.co.uk · 020 3719 8697

STAFF HANDBOOK

Everything a member of staff needs for the first term — how we teach, how we keep children safe, and how the portal works

ACADEMIC YEAR 2026 – 2027

For	All teaching and support staff of Tarbiyyah Global Academy
Owner	Headteacher
Issued	October 2026, for the founding term beginning Monday 7 December 2026
Review	Termly during the founding year
Read alongside	The full policies, published at globalacademy.tarbiyyah.co.uk/policies. Where this handbook summarises a policy, the policy is the authority.

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1. Welcome and who we are

Tarbiyyah Global Academy is a live online school for Year 1 to Year 11, part of the Tarbiyyah Education Trust, which has run Tarbiyyah Primary, Tarbiyyah Secondary School for Boys and Tarbiyyah Al-Banaat in London for over ten years. Our pupils live in many countries; what they share is a specialist education — Qur'an, Arabic and Islamic Studies on the timetable every week alongside the full national curriculum to GCSE — taught with *tarbiyyah*, the nurturing of character and faith, at its heart. Six values, taught by name, run through everything: **R**esilience (sabr), **E**eman, **C**ontentment (shukr), **I**ntegrity (amanah), **P**rogress and **E**xcellence (ihsan). One value is the focus each half term; a RECIPE Star is recognised in every class and every report carries a character comment.

2. The school day

Time (UK)	Session
09:00–09:10	Form time: tutor check-in and wellbeing (the lesson register is taken in each lesson)
09:10–10:00	Lesson 1, then a ten-minute movement break

10:10–11:00	Lesson 2, then a ten-minute movement break
11:10–12:00	Lesson 3 — on Fridays the live day ends here, for Jumu'ah
12:00–13:00	Lunch and Dhuhr
13:00–13:50	Lesson 4
13:50–14:00	Break (extended to 15 minutes for Asr, November–February)
14:00–14:50	Lesson 5
14:50–15:00	End of day; independent work set

Lessons are 30 minutes in Years 1–2 (about two hours of live time a day), 45 minutes in Years 3–6 and 50 minutes in Years 7–11. Classes have no more than 15 pupils. Year 1 to Year 9 families may choose a four-day live week (Friday is a structured independent-study day); Years 10–11 follow the full live timetable. UK time moves forward on 28 March 2027; the timetable stays in UK time.

3. How we teach: the live lesson

Every lesson is taught live on Microsoft Teams for Education, joined by pupils through the Student Portal. Use the same structure every time: retrieval practice; a short, clear explanation; modelling; guided practice with frequent checks (polls, mini-whiteboards, cold-calling); independent practice; a closing check. Work is set and returned through Teams Assignments and Class Notebooks. **Before the lesson:** open the meeting at least five minutes early; check the lobby is on and pupils cannot present by default; have your resources and the Class Notebook ready. **During the lesson:** take the register in the first five minutes (Teams attendance plus the Student Portal); cameras on unless agreed otherwise; chat is for learning and is visible to staff; breakout rooms only where you can drop in and recording continues; move anyone who should not be there out of the meeting and lock it. **After the lesson:** set the independent work, mark attendance anomalies, and log anything the DSL should know the same day.

4. Keeping children safe

If you are worried about a child, you do not wait for certainty: tell the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day through **Report a concern** in the portal. In an emergency, where a child is at immediate risk, contact the emergency services in the child's own country first, then the DSL.

Role	Contact
Designated Safeguarding Lead	Ustadh Abu Zayn Haneef Sandhar, Headteacher · globalacademy@tarbiyyah.co.uk · 020 3719 8697
Deputy DSL	Skander Ahmed · skander@tarbiyyah.co.uk
Chair of Trustees (safeguarding lead trustee)	Moiz Madrasawala · gbchair@tarbiyyah.co.uk
NSPCC helpline (adults worried about a child)	0808 800 5000

What you may see on screen: injuries, tiredness, hunger or poor hygiene; shouting or distress in the background; an unknown adult always present; repeated camera refusal or long unexplained absences;

references to self-harm; contact from strangers or new devices; extreme views. Each is a reason to tell the DSL. Never promise a child confidentiality, never investigate yourself, and write a factual record in the pupil's own words as soon as you can. **If a pupil discloses in a lesson:** stay calm, do not question further in front of the class, arrange an immediate private, recorded follow-up, and tell the DSL straight away.

5. Behaviour: merits and consequences

Merits: **M1** daily consistency (punctual, prepared, camera on, respectful chat, homework on time) · **M2** going further · **M3** exceptional ihsan. Log them in the portal; they feed the RECIPE Star and the half-termly review.

Step	What happens
C1	A private verbal or chat warning in the lesson; a repeat in the same lesson moves to C2
C2	A second warning; the pupil may be moved to a supervised breakout room for the rest of the activity
C3	A virtual reflection session with the Pastoral Lead outside lesson time (30 minutes for punctuality, homework or home-environment issues; 45 minutes for conduct); three C3s in a half term lead to a parent meeting and a monitoring report
C4	Removal from the live lesson; the pupil completes set work independently, attends a supervised catch-up session, and parents are called; three C4s in a half term lead to a review for suspension
C5	A serious incident: immediate suspension of platform access pending Headteacher review, with a parent meeting

All new pupils are on a probationary first half term with a formal review at its end. Pupils must never record, screenshot or share lessons.

6. Marking, feedback and homework

Give whole-class feedback at the start of the next lesson (strengths, misconceptions, next steps), then let pupils improve their work. Key assessed pieces get individual written feedback with at least one clear next step, returned within ten school days. English and Mathematics work is reviewed at least every two weeks; other subjects at least once every half term. Homework is set on Teams Assignments with clear instructions and deadlines, balanced between on-screen and off-screen tasks: Years 1–2 10–20 minutes a day, Years 3–6 20–40 minutes, Years 7–9 45–75 minutes, Years 10–11 1.5–2 hours. A homework timetable for each year group is published at the start of each term so tasks do not pile up on one evening. **Missing homework (the portal tracks this for you):** due date — marked missing; 1 day — pupil and parent see it in their Action centre; 2 days — tell the parent; 3 days — chase the pupil and agree a day; 5 days — escalate to the Headteacher; 3 missed in 14 days — speak to the parent and agree support.

7. Attendance and absence

Take the register in the first five minutes of every lesson. A pupil who joins within the first ten minutes is marked late; after ten minutes the lateness is recorded. Parents report absence before 09:00 UK time on the first day through the Parent Portal; where no reason is given, the office contacts parents by message and phone by 10:00 UK time (or within an hour of the first missed lesson for other time zones). Two

consecutive unexplained days go to the DSL for a welfare call; for pupils in England, ten consecutive unexplained days are reported to the local authority. Record absences in the register, follow them up from **Absences**, and close them once explained — open follow-ups appear in your Action centre.

8. Recording, images and data

Every live lesson, form time, assembly, intervention and club is recorded, and so is every one-to-one session unless the DSL has authorised otherwise. Recordings are for safeguarding, behaviour, complaints, quality assurance and agreed catch-up; they are kept for one academic year and never used for marketing. You may view your own lessons for reflection. Pupils' images are used in materials only with specific written consent, and never with a full name. Pupil data stays on Academy systems only: no personal email, no personal cloud storage, no screenshots of pupil information. Report any suspected breach to the Data Protection Officer within 24 hours. The Data Protection Policy sets out the retention schedule.

9. Your conduct online

- Contact pupils only through Academy platforms, during the Academy day; never by personal phone, email or social media.
- No unrecorded one-to-one video calls; no overly familiar language in chat; no sharing of personal social media.
- Dress and background as you would for a classroom; keep family members out of view and earshot.
- Keep your Academy account secure: unique password, multi-factor authentication, lock your screen.
- If you are concerned about a colleague's conduct, however small, tell the Headteacher (low-level concerns are recorded and reviewed for patterns); you can also use the Whistleblowing Policy.

10. The portal, step by step

Clocking in. Clock in when the portal asks. Your time counts while you use the portal; after 30 minutes with no activity the shift ends at your last activity, and if you return within 15 minutes it carries on without a gap. Closing the portal ends your shift within about ten minutes. Use Clock out when you finish. Ask the Headteacher or an admin to correct a shift; changes are recorded. **Action centre.** Open it each morning: missing homework, absence follow-ups and Qur'an revision, most urgent first. Items clear themselves when the work is done. **Qur'an and Qaidah marks (out of 10).** 0–4 is a fail, 5 or more a pass, 8 or more secure; pick a focus area when something needs work. Schedule one-to-one recitation like a normal lesson. A surah counts as covered once assessed, and comes due for revision again after 3, 7, 14 or 30 days depending on the mark. **Documents and signatures.** Policies you must sign appear in Documents; each is routed to the right staff automatically. Sign before your first lesson. **Report a concern.** Always available, even before you clock in.

11. Who to contact

About	Contact
Safeguarding (any concern)	DSL via Report a concern · globalacademy@tarbiyyah.co.uk · 020 3719 8697
Timetable, cover, lesson problems	Headteacher through the portal messages

A pupil's SEND or medical plan	SENCO through the portal
Behaviour and reflection sessions	Pastoral Lead
Pay, contracts, HR	Tarbiyyah Education Trust office
Technical problems with Teams or the portal	Digital Lead · include the lesson, time and a screenshot

Appendix A — First-week checklist

- Read Keeping Children Safe in Education Part One and the Child Protection and Safeguarding Policy; confirm in Documents.
- Sign every document in your Documents list.
- Test Teams: camera, microphone, screen share, lobby settings, recording.
- Check your classes, Class Notebooks and the published timetable in the portal.
- Save the DSL and Deputy DSL contacts; find Report a concern.
- Complete the home-working self-assessment.

Issued by: Ustadh Abu Zayn Haneef Sandhar, Headteacher Staff Handbook 2026–2027 · Tarbiyyah Global Academy · A specialist education, with the deen at its heart